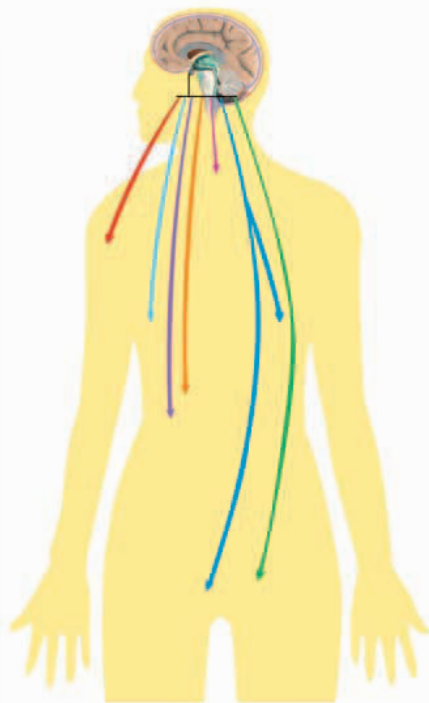


MASTER GLAND



The pituitary gland is about the size of a pea and dangles by a stalk from the base of the brain. Seven different hormones are made in this tiny gland, four of which control endocrine glands elsewhere in the body. For this reason, the pituitary is sometimes called the master gland. Hormones released by the pituitary affect growth, blood pressure, stress, body chemistry, water balance, the production of breast milk in mothers, and the female reproductive cycle.



▲ **INSULIN INJECTOR** *People with diabetes use insulin pens to inject themselves with insulin.*

DRUGS IN SPORTS

The hormone testosterone makes muscles grow larger and stronger. Some athletes try to cheat by taking man-made versions of testosterone before a competition to improve their performance. These drugs are outlawed by most sports organizations, including the International Olympic Committee. Athletes are routinely tested for drugs and disqualified if traces are found in their blood.



LOVE POTION

Oxytocin is a hormone made by brain cells and stored in the pituitary gland. One of its effects is to help create loving bonds between people, including mothers and their babies, couples, and close friends. For this reason it's sometimes called the love hormone. Oxytocin increases trust, reduces fear, and makes you feel happy in the company of people you love.



WOW!

There are more than 50 known hormones made by the human body and scientists are still discovering new ones.